

AMITAVA MUKHERJEE
Chairman and Managing Director

NMDC ENRICHING COMMUNITIES THROUGH RESPONSIBLE MINING

As the Chairman of NMDC, how do you define effective leadership, and what principles guide your leadership style?

Effective leadership is rooted in building a balance between the short-term and long-term goals of the organization, to drive the company's growth. Our approach is based on a strategic plan that harmoniously integrates both immediate and future targets. This plan serves as a roadmap for the company, clearly defining the steps we need to take to achieve our goals and performance metrics that are used to track progress. We ensure that the set goals are SMART - specific, measurable, achievable, realistic and time bound.

This approach is delivering commendable outcomes for NMDC. The implementation of an all-inclusive Pricing Mechanism for iron ore, operationalization of the Kumar Marenga intermediary stockyard, and the achievement of the highest-ever H1 FY24 volumes and the best-ever CAPEX for FY23 & Q1FY24 underscore the company's strategic decision-making and financial prudence.

Empowering the team with decision-making autonomy and building specific responsibility centers through the New Works Organization is a watershed moment for NMDC towards strengthening our capacity building team. This vertical is dedicated for closely monitoring and time-bound execution of our ambitious projects in the pipeline, reflecting a commitment to efficient project management.

The focus is also on building strong relationships with the stakeholders - customers, suppliers, communities living around our mines. The company's transformation to NMDC 2.0 with a vow to Responsible Mining stems from this culture of productivity and harmony in our ecosystem.

In your experience, how has the role of leadership evolved in the mining industry, and what challenges and opportunities does it present?

The Indian mining industry sits on a goldmine of potential - growing market demand, abundant raw material and resources, labour availability, cost advantage, boom in sister and downstream industries and government policy support. The leadership of today is responsible for leveraging them to enhance production, fuel self-reliance and contribute to India's journey of becoming a 5 trillion dollar economy.

While there are opportunities galore, there are certain challenges that need the industry's attention. Digitalization needs to be given a fillip, logistics infrastructure require further augmentation, statutory and environmental clearances have to be fast tracked. We need to strengthen our mines and supply chains to ensure that the true potential of the industry is achieved.

The advent of digital technology has profoundly transformed the accessibility and richness of data available to mining companies, enabling a shift towards automation. A digitally empowered mining sector comes with the promise of optimal resource utilization and mineral accountability.

As one of India's leading mining majors, NMDC has been an early adopter of automation and digitalization. We are consistently investing capital in building smart and sustainable mines. Some recent technological interventions that are optimizing processes, minimizing waste,